

Tajinderpal Singh Toor

Tajinderpal Singh Toor arrives at Aichi-Nagoya with a chance to become the first Indian shot putter to win three successive Asian Games titles. Champion at Jakarta and Hangzhou, he has found 21-metre form, recording 21.03m this season, his best throw in two

years. That mark places him ahead of China's Xing Jiali, who reached 20.95m indoors, and Iran's Mohammad Reza Tayebi, whose national record stands at 20.75m. Saudi Arabia's Asian record-holder Mohammed Tolu, the Hangzhou silver medallist, remains the principal threat. Toor's fifth-place finish at the Commonwealth Games came with 20.27m despite a Grade-1

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tear, underlining the competitive level he can maintain below full fitness. His strength lies not only in distance but in championship temperament: at Hangzhou, he recovered from two opening fouls and produced the winning 20.36m in the final round. If he settles early near 20.50m, his 21-metre capacity and experience make him a leading gold-medal contender.

